

## ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 1/12: Culture as power, technique and labour

### SULTANATE CULTURE

- > POWER: conquest, patronage, legitimacy and memory
- > TECHNIQUE: trabeate + arcuate + mortar + dome transition
- > LABOUR: masons, stonecutters, designers and material supply
- > EXPRESSION: monuments, language, literature, music and institutions

VERDICT: architecture is the main archive, not the whole cultural field.

MUST REMEMBER: Trabeate and arcuate techniques interacted through adaptation, reuse, experimentation and dynastic patronage.

## ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 2/12: Trabeate and arcuate load paths

TRABEATE -> vertical posts carry a horizontal lintel  
CORBEL -> horizontal courses project inward; opening is not radially loaded  
TRUE ARCH -> wedge voussoirs radiate; thrust moves into piers/abutments  
DOME -> square-to-circle/polygon transition may use squinch or pendentive  
LIME MORTAR + CENTRING + CURING + CUTTING -> material/workshop system  
COEXISTENCE -> slab/beam, corbel, arch, vault and dome continue together  
RULE: identify fabric/load path before assigning date, patron or invention.

## ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 3/12: Rupture, reuse and adaptation

QUWWAT-UL-ISLAM -> reused pillars + new ritual and political programme

ARHAI DIN KA JHONPRA -> early conversion/adaptation and new facade

SPOLIA -> evidence of appropriation and material reuse

WORKSHOP -> local carving and construction choices remain visible

LIMIT -> one documented complex cannot prove a universal policy

SAFE FORMULA -> rupture + adaptation + technical synthesis.

## ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 4/12: Qutb complex as layered patronage

AIBAK -> Quwwat-ul-Islam foundation/reuse + Minar initiation

ILTUTMISH -> mosque/Minar expansion + own tomb; Sultan Ghari elsewhere

ALAUDDIN -> mosque enlargement + Alai Darwaza + madrasa + Alai Minar base

LATER REPAIR -> Firuz and other interventions alter surviving Minar fabric

EVIDENCE -> inscription + masonry bond + reused carving + plan + repair record

SPOLIA -> appropriation/reuse/adaptation; no one motive fits every fragment

VERDICT: one complex contains several patrons, phases, functions and meanings.

## ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 5/12: Balban to Alai technical sequence

ILTUTMISH TOMB -> square-to-dome transition experiment

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BALBAN TOMB -> first surviving true arch in the assigned source

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ALAI DARWAZA -> mature radiating voussoirs, dome and proportion

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KHALJI URBAN AMBITION -> Siri and the incomplete Alai programme

TRAP: mature mastery is not the same claim as first surviving example.

## ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 6/12: Tughlaq form and inference discipline

GHIYAS -> Tughlaqabad + tomb + platform/causeway/water setting

MUHAMMAD -> Jahanpanah + Adilabad; boundaries and functions partly uncertain

FIRUZ -> Kotla/Firozabad + pillar + repairs + Hauz Khas madrasa/tomb

FABRIC -> batter + rubble core + facing/plaster + trabeate/arcuate combination

CITY -> fort + court + mosque + stores + roads + hydraulic provisioning

DO NOT INFER -> poverty, insecurity, ideology or Egyptian origin from slope alone

RULE: observed fabric first; economic/political explanation second and qualified.

## ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 7/12: Regional adaptation matrix

BENGAL -> brick/terracotta + curved forms | rainfall/material context  
GUJARAT -> stone screens/pillars/brackets | local workshop/merchant setting  
MALWA -> Mandu platform/mass/colour | plateau-lake capital  
JAUNPUR -> emphatic portals/proportion | distinct regional mosque idiom  
KASHMIR -> timber-masonry/tiered roofs | valley materials/climate  
DECCAN -> Gulbarga/Bidar + plaster/tile/madrassa | Topic 09 political owner  
RULE: shared repertoire became regional form, not inferior Delhi copies.

## ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 8/12: Ornament and visual grammar

CALLIGRAPHY -> script becomes visual through scale and placement

ARABESQUE -> geometric-vegetal pattern joined to inscription

LOCAL MOTIFS -> lotus, bell and swastika in adapted workshop vocabularies

COLOUR / MATERIAL -> sandstone, marble and surface contrast

RELIGIOUS SPACE -> often non-figural, but avoid an absolute for all contexts

USE: surface grammar supports synthesis only when tied to a monument.



## ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 9/12: Building types and social functions

MOSQUE -> congregation, ritual orientation and community visibility

MINAR -> elevated landmark and call-to-prayer association

TOMB -> burial memory, patronage and skyline

MADRASA -> learning and learned patronage

KHANQAH -> Sufi discipline, teaching, hospitality and community

FORT / CITY -> defence, residence, supply, water and political theatre.

## ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 10/12: Language, literature and music

PERSIAN -> chancery + chronicle + poetry | ARABIC -> law/religious scholarship  
SANSKRIT -> continuing scholastic/court worlds | HINDAVI/REGIONAL -> plural publics  
AUTHORS -> Hasan Nizami + Minhaj + Khusrau + Barani + Isami + Afif  
GENRES -> panegyric, dynastic history, normative advice and verse history differ  
MUSIC -> sama/qawwali genealogy + court/popular performance  
CAUTION -> Khusrau is not safely sole inventor of tabla, sitar or qawwali  
BOOK ARTS -> paper/copying/calligraphy/painting survive unevenly.  
CLOSE DISTINCTION: Qutb complex, Alai Darwaza and Tughlaqabad must be read through feature,  
phase and political context.

## ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 11/12: Evidence and conservation ladder

1 INSCRIPTION -> patron/date/text/repair claim

2 FABRIC/STRATIGRAPHY -> construction phase, joint, reuse and alteration

3 PLAN/OBJECT -> function, circulation, material and workshop evidence

4 CHRONICLE/MANUSCRIPT -> patronage claim with genre bias

5 CONSERVATION RECORD -> replaced fabric, condition and modern name

6 UNESCO/ASI -> present authenticity/management, not medieval motive

RULE: reconstruction must mark certain, probable and speculative layers.

EVIDENCE LIMIT: Spolia or stylistic borrowing cannot by itself establish one motive, community relation or linear architectural rupture.

## ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 12/12: Topic 11 answer spine

DEFINE -> precise structural/cultural term; reject one Sultanate style

SEQUENCE -> Mamluk -> Khalji -> Tughlaq -> Sayyid/Lodi

MECHANISM -> material + load path + workshop + labour + water/city

CULTURE -> language + text + education + music + manuscript + crafts

COMPARE -> Delhi phase + one bounded regional adaptation

LIMIT -> inscription/fabric/chronicle/conservation and uncertain function

VERDICT -> rupture, localisation and negotiation without seamless synthesis.